Pedagogy Compass

Start from what is going wrong. Each problem lists the models that address it, strongest evidence first.

They forget everything by the test

1. Retrieval practice **Strong**
2. Spaced practice **Strong**
3. Interleaving Promising
4. Elaboration Promising

They don't get started

1. Cognitive load and worked examples **Strong**
2. Explicit instruction **Strong**
3. Metacognition and self-regulation **Strong**
4. Motivation theories Framework

Discussions die

1. Collaborative learning **Strong**
2. Reciprocal teaching **Strong**
3. Dialogic teaching Promising
4. ICAP Framework

Mixed levels in one class

1. Mastery learning **Strong**
2. Formative assessment **Strong**
3. Universal Design for Learning Promising
4. Gradual release of responsibility Framework

They copy AI answers

1. Retrieval practice **Strong**
2. Metacognition and self-regulation **Strong**
3. Generative learning Promising
4. Desirable difficulties Framework

My lessons overload them

1. Cognitive load and worked examples **Strong**
2. Explicit instruction **Strong**
3. Dual coding and multimedia principles Promising
4. Information processing model Framework

They can do it with me, but not alone

1. Explicit instruction **Strong**
2. Metacognition and self-regulation **Strong**
3. Concrete examples Promising
4. Gradual release of responsibility Framework

They don't know what good work looks like

1. Feedback **Strong**
2. Formative assessment **Strong**
3. SOLO and constructive alignment Framework

Some students have stopped trying

1. Feedback **Strong**
2. Growth mindset Promising
3. Motivation theories Framework

I can't tell who has understood until the test

1. Formative assessment **Strong**
2. Retrieval practice **Strong**
3. SOLO and constructive alignment Framework

About fifty models, six categories

(A) Strong

Retrieval practice
Spaced practice
Cognitive load and worked examples
Explicit instruction
Feedback
Metacognition and self-regulation
Mastery learning
Collaborative learning
Reciprocal teaching
Formative assessment

(B) Promising

Interleaving
Elaboration
Concrete examples
Dual coding and multimedia principles
Flipped classroom
Growth mindset
Productive failure
Dialogic teaching
Universal Design for Learning
Generative learning

(C) Framework

Prior knowledge and advance organisers
Bloom's taxonomy
SOLO and constructive alignment
Backward design
Gradual release of responsibility
Rosenshine's principles of instruction
Desirable difficulties
ICAP
Variation theory
Motivation theories
Visible Learning
Kolb's learning cycle
Information processing model
Executive functions
Neuroplasticity
The social brain

(D) Theory

Behaviorism
Cognitivism
Constructivism
Sociocultural theory
Progressivism
Critical pedagogy
Humanistic perspective

(E) School model

Montessori
Waldorf (Steiner) education
Reggio Emilia
Freinet

(F) Contested or myth

Learning styles (VAK)
Multiple intelligences as a teaching method
Brain and working-memory training

Strong Meta-analyses of classroom studies show that teaching this way improves learning. Promising Controlled studies show gains, but results are mixed, small in number or dependent on context. Framework A useful structure for planning, with no intervention studies behind it as a method. Theory A way of explaining how learning happens. It shapes values and choices, but cannot be tested as a single intervention. School model A whole-school movement with its own philosophy and practice. Contested The research does not support using it as a teaching method, even though many teachers believe in it.

Ask any AI tool

Describe the problem, your subject and grade, and the approaches you are considering, strongest evidence first. Then ask for the reply in this format:

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Reply in plain text, no tables, in exactly this format:
BEST FIRST STEP: which approach to try first and why, given what the teacher sees
NEXT LESSON: what it looks like in one concrete lesson in this subject, with minutes
WATCH FOR: how the teacher will know within two weeks whether it is working
AI: one way AI could help the teacher with this, and one way students' use of AI could make the problem
worse
HONEST NOTE: what the evidence label means for this approach, in one or two lines
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